

Sport

Disappointing result for both

This was a must-win for both, but in the end they had to settle for a draw which is almost equivalent to a defeat.

Sirens are in the dire straits in the lower part of the table and at least the three points would have lifted some of their residual hopes of maintaining their Premiership status.

However they missed this opportunity and will now need a sporting miracle to avoid the drop.

They fought bravely after going behind and obtained a deserved draw, but this does not help their cause.

On the other side Marsaxlokk missed another opportunity to inch closer to third-placed Sliema, who collected only three points in their last three outings.

But the point earned leaves them five points behind the Wanderers, as Birkirkara are now only two points adrift in fifth place after their last gasp victory over Valletta.

In the 11th minute, a cross from the left by Fernando Gomes and a quick shot by Yuri Messias ended up high over the crossbar.

Marsaxlokk took the lead on 23 minutes from a direct free-kick by Leandro Aguirre who slot in



Top: Leandro Aguirre (C) of Marsaxlokk celebrates scoring against Sirens during the first half. Photo © Nicholas Falzon

BOV CHALLENGE LEAGUE

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Yesterday	
Promotion Group	
Marsa-Zabbar.....	1-3
Relegation Group	
Luqa-Msida	2-0
Lija-Tarxien	0-4
Swieqi-Zebbug.....	3-1

BOV Premier League

2023-24

GUDJA UNITED

1945

0

GUDJA

J. Spiteri
R. Muchardi
L. Gatt
A. Quintero
R. Mendes
S. Chukwuemeka
R. Nanitelamio
Z. Grech
A. Friggieri
M. Esposito
G. Joseph

HAMRUN

H. Bonello
L. Montebello
R. Prsa
E. Freitas
U. Duranovic
E. Domingos
O. Bjelicic
JC. Corbalan
S. Paintsil
E. Marcelina
R. Camenzuli

4

Referee: Darryl Agius

STANDINGS

	P	W	D	L	F	A	Pts
Hamrun	16	13	2	1	40	11	41
Floriana	16	12	2	2	31	7	38
Sliema	16	9	4	3	17	7	31
Marsaxlokk	16	7	5	4	27	16	26
Birkirkara	16	7	3	6	18	17	24
Hibernians	16	7	3	6	19	16	24
Naxxar	16	5	6	5	18	24	21
Balzan	16	5	4	7	14	21	19
Valletta	16	4	6	6	16	14	18
Gzira	16	5	3	8	23	24	18
Mosta	16	3	8	5	9	17	17
Santa Lucia	16	4	3	9	10	26	15
Sirens	16	1	5	10	8	28	8
Gudja	16	0	6	10	9	31	6

the roof of the net.

A minute later, Sirens responded with a powerful shot by Nicholas Pulis, which the goalkeeper Drobnjak blocked with difficulty.

In the 37th minute, Sunday Akinbule managed to outrun a Sirens defender, but his powerful shot hit the upright post.

Sirens were more offensive at the beginning of the second half, and barely a minute in, they protested for a penalty, when Gilberto Martins was floored in the box, but referee Farrugia ordered a corner.

Sirens finally managed to equalise on 55 minutes, when Degran Jackson's effort was im-

possible for goalkeeper Drobnjak to save.

In the 70th minute, Bismark Asare continued to advance on the right, but his final shot was turned into a corner by Drobnjak. In the 77th minute, Degran Jackson beat two defenders on the left but his shot was well saved by Drobnjak.

BOV Premier League

2023-24

SIRENS

S. Cassar
D. Borrero
P. Owusu
N. Pulis
H. Panayiotou
G. Martins
K. Ntampizas
B. Asare
S. Borg
K. Donsu
Kemmu

1

MARSAXLOKK

M. Drobnjak
K. Micallef
J. Ghio
Y. Messias
D. Bonnici
J. Walker
L. Aguirre
N. Raden
D. Pires
S. Akinbule
JF. Gomes JR

1

Scorers: Aguirre 24', Jaskson 55'

Yellow cards: Jackson, Pulis, Fernandinho, Borg